Stroke and Turn Official Apprenticeship Form
Coach / Athlete
Minnesota Swimming

Name: _____ Club: _____

Email: _____

Current and former USA Swimming coaches with **5+ years of experience**, and **athletes** who have competed for **5+ years as 13-and-over swimmers**, bring valuable insights to the officiating community. Their background may allow for accelerated training toward becoming a Stroke and Turn Official.

To support this transition, experienced ST Officials will guide you through two (2) apprentice sessions, covering all essential knowledge and skills needed to become a successful USA Swimming Stroke and Turn Official.

When complete, scan the QR code to upload a photo of this application.

Prior to Apprenticing	**Date**
• Create an online account with USA Swimming	
• Register as a member of USA Swimming as an Apprentice Official ○ Apprentice membership is at no cost and valid for (60) sixty days ○ After (60) days, you must re-register as a Non-Athlete member to continue.	
Prior to Certification for Apprentice members / Prior to Apprenticing for Non-Athlete Members	**Date**
• Re-register as a Non-Athlete member with fee.	
• Complete Athlete Protection Training (APT)	
• Complete USA Swimming Background Check	
• Complete Concussion Training and email certificate to the Minnesota Swimming Office at tmeece@mnswim.org	
Prior to Certification	**Date**
• Complete Foundations of Officiating Course in USA Swimming University.	

Apprentice Sessions – complete a minimum of ***2 sessions***

	Date	Meet Host	Print Names	Location	Ages
1			Trainer: Meet Ref:	☐ Home ☐ Away	☐ 12 & Under ☐ 13 & Over
2			Trainer: Meet Ref:	☐ Home ☐ Away	☐ 12 & Under ☐ 13 & Over
Optional **3**			Trainer: Meet Ref:	☐ Home ☐ Away	☐ 12 & Under ☐ 13 & Over

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Please briefly describe your swimming experience here. List club, high school, and/or collegiate experience and number of years.

Performance Assessment (Completed by your trainer during your final apprentice session.)

Trainer Assessment Code	"Y" – demonstrated satisfactorily; "N" – demonstrated unsatisfactorily; "ND" – not demonstrated
	Arrives on time, prepared with necessary equipment, and in proper professional attire.
	Is respectful of other officials, coaches, volunteers, spectators, and athletes.
	Understands and applies proper positioning on deck.
	Understands and applies communicated jurisdictions and protocols.
	Understands and applies the rules for the start, stroke, kick, turn, and finish for the butterfly.
	Understands and applies the rules for the start, stroke, kick, turn, and finish for the backstroke.
	Understands and applies the rules for the start, stroke, kick, turn, and finish for the breaststroke.
	Understands and applies the rules for the start, stroke, kick, turn, and finish for the freestyle.
	Understands and applies the rules for the individual medley.
	Understands and applies the rules for relays and relay takeoffs.
	Is comfortable making calls as appropriate and understands when they are not appropriate.
	Correctly communicates a disqualification and what was observed using USA Swimming Rulebook language.
	Always gives the swimmer the benefit of the doubt.
	Understands performance criteria as outlined in the Storke and Turn Judge professional document.
	Understands and adheres to USA Swimming Safe Sport and MAPP rules.

If any skill was not met or observed, write a development plan to help the Apprentice achieve their certification – e.g. additional apprentice sessions, re-watching a clinic, review the rulebook, etc. Discuss and provide the development plan to the Apprentice and send a copy to the Minnesota Swimming Officials Chair at mnoc.swim@gmail.com. The written development plan must be completed by the Apprentice **PRIOR** to certification being granted.

PRINT NAME of Trainer: _____ Date: _____

Signature of Trainer: _____

PRINT NAME of Meet Referee: _____ Date: _____

Signature of Meet Referee: _____